MODULE 5

Project Earth

"Only if we understand, can we care. Only if we care, will we help. Only if we help shall all be saved."

— JANE GOODALL

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How can caring for Earth and its living things improve life now and in the future?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Potatoes on Rooftops**	· Hadley Dyer	PERSUASIVE TEXT
2	**Living Green**	· Doreen Beauregard (illus. Tuesday Mourning)	PLAY
3	**The Good Garden**	· Katie Smith Milway (illus. Sylvie Daigneault)	REALISTIC FICTION
4	**Parrots Over Puerto Rico**	· Susan L. Roth & Cindy Trumbore	INFORMATIONAL TEXT

CONTENTS

A · Vocabulary (29) ..... p. 2

B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 6

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 12

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 15

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 5 · Project Earth · Grade 5 · 29 Items

CCSS L.5.4 · L.5.5 · L.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.5.6

imperil

To **imperil** something is to —

- ◯ **A.** keep it perfectly safe.
- ◯ **B.** protect it from harm.
- ◯ **C.** put it in danger.
- ◯ **D.** rescue it from trouble.

Q2 L.5.6

endangered

An animal that is **endangered** is —

- ◯ **A.** at risk of great harm or of dying out.
- ◯ **B.** safe and growing in number.
- ◯ **C.** kept as a pet in a home.
- ◯ **D.** larger than all other animals.

Q3 L.5.5 TRAP

contaminate

To **contaminate** something is to —

- ◯ **A.** make it cleaner and purer.
- ◯ **B.** add a harmful substance to it.
- ◯ **C.** count how much of it there is.
- ◯ **D.** move it to a new place.

Q4 L.5.6

benevolent

A **benevolent** person or thing is —

- ◯ **A.** selfish and unkind.
- ◯ **B.** strict and demanding.
- ◯ **C.** careless and lazy.
- ◯ **D.** kind and generous.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · POTATOES ON ROOFTOPS

Q5 L.5.4

urban

The book describes **urban** gardens. Something that is **urban** is —

- ◯ **A.** related to a city.
- ◯ **B.** found deep in a forest.
- ◯ **C.** located under the ocean.
- ◯ **D.** high up on a mountain.

Q6 L.5.4

humble

If something is **humble**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** grand and expensive.
- ◯ **B.** fancy and showy.
- ◯ **C.** simple or modest.
- ◯ **D.** proud and boastful.

Q7 L.5.4

plots

Millions of garden **plots** were planted. **Plots** are —

- ◯ **A.** tools used for digging.
- ◯ **B.** small sections of land used for a certain purpose.
- ◯ **C.** bags of garden seeds.
- ◯ **D.** kinds of fresh vegetables.

Q8 L.5.4

alternative

When there is no room to spread out, one **alternative** is to grow upward. An **alternative** is —

- ◯ **A.** a problem with no answer.
- ◯ **B.** a tool for measuring land.
- ◯ **C.** a list of garden rules.
- ◯ **D.** a choice or option that can take the place of something.

Q9 L.5.5 TRAP

transform

Vertical gardens can **transform** a plain wall. To **transform** something is to —

- ◯ **A.** change it from one thing into another.
- ◯ **B.** keep it exactly the same.
- ◯ **C.** take a picture of it.
- ◯ **D.** carry it to a new place.

Q10 L.5.5 TRAP

artificial

Indoor farms may need **artificial** growing lights. Something that is **artificial** is —

- ◯ **A.** grown wild in nature.
- ◯ **B.** created by humans rather than nature.
- ◯ **C.** very old and rare.
- ◯ **D.** too small to see.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · POTATOES ON ROOFTOPS (CONTINUED)

Q11 L.5.4

yield

Some vegetables will **yield** seeds you can save. To **yield** means to —

- ◯ **A.** throw something away.
- ◯ **B.** wash something clean.
- ◯ **C.** hide something from view.
- ◯ **D.** produce or create something.

Q12 L.5.5 TRAP

influence

Soil quality can **influence** how plants grow. If you **influence** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** have no effect on it at all.
- ◯ **B.** count it one by one.
- ◯ **C.** affect or help cause a certain outcome.
- ◯ **D.** draw a picture of it.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · LIVING GREEN

Q13 L.5.4

reduce

To **reduce** something is to —

- ◯ **A.** decrease the size or amount of it.
- ◯ **B.** make much more of it.
- ◯ **C.** paint it a new color.
- ◯ **D.** give it away as a gift.

Q14 L.5.4

conscious

The friends try to be environmentally **conscious**. To be **conscious** of something is to —

- ◯ **A.** be bored by it.
- ◯ **B.** be afraid of it.
- ◯ **C.** be aware of it.
- ◯ **D.** be far away from it.

Q15 L.5.5 TRAP

implying

"Are you **implying** that we aren't?" Bo asks. If you are **implying** something, you are —

- ◯ **A.** stating it loudly and directly.
- ◯ **B.** suggesting it without saying it directly.
- ◯ **C.** asking about it.
- ◯ **D.** writing it down.

Q16 L.5.4

contradict

"Do our actions **contradict** our words?" Grace asks. To **contradict** something is to —

- **A.** agree with it completely.
- **B.** repeat it word for word.
- **C.** explain it clearly.
- **D.** say or do the opposite of it.

Q17 L.5.5 TRAP

cascading

Bo looks at a vine **cascading** from a plant. Something that is **cascading** is —

- **A.** falling or flowing like a waterfall.
- **B.** standing perfectly still.
- **C.** rising straight up.
- **D.** frozen into ice.

Q18 L.5.4

depleted

Bo picks up a **depleted** glue stick. Something that is **depleted** is —

- **A.** brand new.
- **B.** very large.
- **C.** used up or worn out.
- **D.** brightly colored.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE GOOD GARDEN

Q19 L.5.4

spectacle

Many people come to see the **spectacle** of the new terraces. A **spectacle** is —

- **A.** a pair of reading glasses.
- **B.** an unusual or interesting sight.
- **C.** a quiet, empty field.
- **D.** a kind of garden tool.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE GOOD GARDEN (CONTINUED)

Q20 L.5.4

toddles

Baby Pepito **toddles** out to the garden. When a child **toddles**, he or she —

- **A.** runs very fast.
- **B.** sits down and rests.
- **C.** climbs a tall tree.
- **D.** walks with short, unsteady steps.

Q21 L.5.4

packet

Don Pedro gives Maria Luz a **packet** of radish seeds. A **packet** is —

- **A.** a small container or envelope.
- **B.** a large wooden box.
- **C.** a deep hole in the ground.
- **D.** a row of growing plants.

Q22 L.5.5 TRAP

retreat

Maria Luz watches the coyote's shadow **retreat**. If you **retreat**, you —

- **A.** march straight forward.
- **B.** stand completely still.
- **C.** move back or away from something.
- **D.** jump up and down.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · PARROTS OVER PUERTO RICO

Q23 L.5.4

flight

Readers see the parrots' bright blue **flight** feathers. **Flight** is —

- **A.** the act of resting on a branch.
- **B.** the act of flying through the air.
- **C.** the act of building a nest.
- **D.** the act of finding food.

Q24 L.5.4

toil

To **toil** is to —

- ◯ **A.** work.
- ◯ **B.** sleep.
- ◯ **C.** sing.
- ◯ **D.** hide.

Q25 L.5.4

merchant

The text mentions **merchant** ships in the harbor. A **merchant** is —

- ◯ **A.** a person who paints pictures.
- ◯ **B.** a person who flies airplanes.
- ◯ **C.** a person who teaches school.
- ◯ **D.** a person who sells products.

Q26 L.5.5 TRAP

fort

The Boricuas built a **fort** with thick walls. A **fort** is —

- ◯ **A.** an open field with no walls.
- ◯ **B.** a small fishing boat.
- ◯ **C.** a strong building protected by guards and a wall.
- ◯ **D.** a market where goods are sold.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · PARROTS OVER PUERTO RICO (CONTINUED)

Q27 L.5.4

jabbing

If you are **jabbing** something, you are —

- ◯ **A.** gently petting it.
- ◯ **B.** poking it quickly with a great deal of power.
- ◯ **C.** quietly looking at it.
- ◯ **D.** slowly lifting it up.

Q28 L.5.4

captivity

Some parrots were raised in **captivity**. If something is kept in **captivity**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** set free in the open wild.
- ◯ **B.** lost and never found.
- ◯ **C.** sold at a busy market.
- ◯ **D.** held in a place and cannot get out.

Q29 L.5.5 TRAP

aggressive

Scientists kept the more **aggressive** parrots apart. If something is **aggressive**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** angry and ready to attack.
- ◯ **B.** calm and gentle.
- ◯ **C.** tired and sleepy.
- ◯ **D.** small and weak.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 5 · Project Earth · Grade 5 · 32 Items

CCSS RI.5.1 · RI.5.2 · RI.5.3 · RI.5.5 · RI.5.6 · RI.5.8 · RL.5.1 · RL.5.2 · RL.5.3 · RL.5.5 · RL.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Potatoes on Rooftops

PERSUASIVE TEXT · HADLEY DYER · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.5.2

What is "Potatoes on Rooftops" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How a family in Honduras saved their farm.
- ◯ **B.** How scientists brought back an endangered bird.
- ◯ **C.** Why and how people can grow food in cities, even where space is limited.
- ◯ **D.** How three friends made a poster about recycling.

Q2 RI.5.3

According to the text, why were victory gardens started during World War I?

- ◯ **A.** Cities were running out of food, so people grew food on a small scale closer to home.
- ◯ **B.** People wanted prettier yards to look at.
- ◯ **C.** The government banned all farms in the countryside.
- ◯ **D.** Gardening had become a popular new sport.

Q3 RI.5.3

What is a "vertical garden," or "living wall," as the author describes it?

- ◯ **A.** A garden planted on the roof of a barn.
- ◯ **B.** A field that stretches far across the ground.
- ◯ **C.** A garden grown only inside glass jars.
- ◯ **D.** Plants grown upward on a wall, turning brick or concrete into edible, artistic space.

Q4 RI.5.8

What evidence does the author give that victory gardens worked?

- ◯ **A.** The gardens were planted only by famous people.
- ◯ **B.** The number of garden plots rose into the millions, and more than 20 million plots were planted during World War II.
- ◯ **C.** The gardens were all grown on the rooftops of skyscrapers.
- ◯ **D.** No one ever planted a garden again after the war.

Q5 RI.5.6

What is the author's main purpose in writing "Potatoes on Rooftops"?

- ◯ **A.** To persuade readers that growing food in cities is valuable and possible.
- ◯ **B.** To tell a funny made-up story about a potato.
- ◯ **C.** To teach readers how to drive a tractor.
- ◯ **D.** To list every vegetable grown in the world.

Q6 RI.5.3

According to the text, what is one thing a person should think about before starting an urban garden?

- ◯ **A.** Which color to paint the house.
- ◯ **B.** How far away the nearest ocean is.
- ◯ **C.** What kind of music the plants like.
- ◯ **D.** How much space, sunlight, time, and money the garden will need.

Q7 RI.5.5

How does the author mainly organize this persuasive text?

- ◯ **A.** As a single rhyming poem.
- ◯ **B.** With headings that present problems city gardeners face and the solutions people have tried.
- ◯ **C.** As a list of cooking directions.
- ◯ **D.** As a play with characters and scenes.

Q8 RI.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a central idea of "Potatoes on Rooftops"?

- ◯ **A.** Choosing the right vegetables to plant is the hardest part of city gardening.
- ◯ **B.** Victory gardens during the world wars were only a temporary wartime idea.
- ◯ **C.** With creativity, people can find many ways to grow food in cities for healthier, greener communities.
- ◯ **D.** Rooftop gardens are the single best way to grow food anywhere in the world.

Selection 2 · Living Green

PLAY · DOREEN BEAUREGARD (ILLUS. TUESDAY MOURNING) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.5.2

What are the friends in "Living Green" trying to do at the start of the play?

- ◯ **A.** Plant a vegetable garden on a rooftop.
- ◯ **B.** Make the final version of a "Reduce, Reuse, Recycle" poster for class.
- ◯ **C.** Save an endangered bird from hawks.
- ◯ **D.** Sell radishes at the village market.

Q10 RL.5.3

What question does Grace ask that makes her friends stop and think?

- ◯ **A.** "Where did we put the scissors?"
- ◯ **B.** "How long have we been playing this game?"
- ◯ **C.** "Should we use a brand-new piece of poster board?"
- ◯ **D.** "Has what we read changed what we do? Do our actions contradict our words?"

Q11 RL.5.3

Instead of using a new piece of poster board, what does Grace suggest the friends do?

- ◯ **A.** Turn over the board they used for the draft and make the final poster on the other side.
- ◯ **B.** Throw the old board away and buy two new ones.
- ◯ **C.** Give up on the poster completely.
- ◯ **D.** Paint the wall instead of using a poster.

Q12 RL.5.3

Why do Eva and Bo decide NOT to have Bo's dad make a special trip for a new glue stick?

- ◯ **A.** The store was closed for the day.
- ◯ **B.** They decided they did not need glue at all.
- ◯ **C.** An extra car trip would burn more gas, so they ask him to buy one while he is already out.
- ◯ **D.** Bo's dad refused to go to the store.

Q13 RL.5.6

How does Bo's attitude change from the beginning of the play to the end?

- ◯ **A.** She starts out caring deeply and then stops caring.
- ◯ **B.** She is angry the whole time and never changes.
- ◯ **C.** She is the one who first questions the group.
- ◯ **D.** She moves from saying "no big deal" to deciding the group needs to change its "mindset."

Q14 RL.5.5

How can you tell that "Living Green" is a play?

- **A.** It is written as a series of rhyming verses.
- **B.** It has a cast of characters, a setting line, dialogue, and stage directions in parentheses.
- **C.** It is a list of facts with photographs and captions.
- **D.** It has chapter titles and an index at the back.

Q15 RL.5.3

What "reduce" idea does Bo come up with after looking at her mom's plants?

- **A.** Catch the cold shower water in a container and use it to water plants instead of wasting it.
- **B.** Turn up the heat whenever someone feels chilly.
- **C.** Buy a brand-new watering can for the plants.
- **D.** Move all the plants outside into the rain.

Q16 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states the theme of "Living Green"?

- **A.** Making a good poster matters more than how the group treats the planet.
- **B.** Saving the planet should be left to adults and scientists, not to students.
- **C.** Small, everyday actions add up, so changing our mindset can make a big difference for the planet.
- **D.** Reusing old materials is too much trouble when new ones are easy to buy.

Selection 3 · The Good Garden

REALISTIC FICTION · KATIE SMITH MILWAY (ILLUS. SYLVIE DAIGNEAULT) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.5.2

What is "The Good Garden" mostly about?

- **A.** A girl in Honduras who learns new ways to garden and helps feed and protect her family.
- **B.** Three friends who make a recycling poster.
- **C.** Scientists who save an endangered parrot.
- **D.** A city that builds gardens on its rooftops.

Q18 RL.5.3

Why has Maria Luz's father left home at the start of the story?

- **A.** He went to the city to sell the family's farm.
- **B.** He went to find a new teacher for the school.
- **C.** Drought and insects ruined the crops, so he went away to find work.
- **D.** He went to buy a burro at the market.

Q19 RL.5.3

What does Don Pedro teach Maria Luz to do to make the land good again?

- **A.** Burn all the old leaves and plant waste.
- **B.** "Feed the soil" by making compost and building terraces, and plant marigolds to keep insects away.
- **C.** Borrow seeds from the coyote each season.
- **D.** Move the whole family to the highlands.

Q20 RL.5.3

Who is Señor Lobo, and why is he a threat to Maria Luz?

- **A.** A kind neighbor who helps her plant radishes.
- **B.** Another teacher at the village school.
- **C.** Maria Luz's uncle from the highlands.
- **D.** The local "coyote," a grain buyer who wants to take her cash crops to market for her.

Q21 RL.5.3

How does the story end for Maria Luz and her family?

- **A.** The coyote takes all of her radishes.
- **B.** The whole garden is ruined by a storm.
- **C.** Papa returns home with money for seeds and is proud of all Maria Luz has learned and grown.
- **D.** Maria Luz moves away to live with Don Pedro.

Q22 RL.5.6

In the illustrations, Señor Lobo is drawn as an actual coyote rather than a man. What does this help readers understand?

- **A.** The villagers see him as a predator who threatens and takes from them.
- **B.** He is a gentle animal who helps the garden.
- **C.** The story is really about wild animals, not people.
- **D.** He is only a character in Maria Luz's dream.

Q23 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of "The Good Garden"?

- **A.** Growing fast-sprouting radishes is the surest way for any farmer to get rich.
- **B.** A family in trouble should sell its land and move to the city to find work.
- **C.** Planting marigolds is the only thing a gardener really needs to do.
- **D.** Learning to care for the soil can take a family from hunger to having enough.

Q24 RL.5.1

Which detail BEST shows that Maria Luz passes on what she has learned?

- **A.** She slides onto a bench beside her friend Alfredo.
- **B.** Pepito toddles out and pats compost onto a terrace, "just as he has seen his big sister do."
- **C.** She thinks about her father in the highlands.
- **D.** She walks to school in the dry, dusty wind.

Selection 4 · Parrots Over Puerto Rico

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · SUSAN L. ROTH & CINDY TRUMBORE (COLLAGES SUSAN L. ROTH) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RI.5.2

What is "Parrots Over Puerto Rico" mostly about?

- **A.** How a city grew its food on rooftops.
- **B.** How a girl saved her family's farm.
- **C.** How a class made a poster about being green.
- **D.** How the Puerto Rican parrot nearly disappeared and how people worked to save it.

Q26 RI.5.3

According to the text, what caused the parrots to begin disappearing?

- **A.** The parrots flew away to a different country.
- **B.** People cut down the forests where the parrots nested, and people hunted and trapped them.
- **C.** The parrots stopped laying eggs on their own.
- **D.** A single storm carried all of them out to sea.

Q27 RI.5.3

According to the text, how did the Puerto Rican Parrot Recovery Program try to save the parrots?

- **A.** By moving the parrots to a zoo in another country.
- **B.** By teaching the parrots to live in city parks.
- **C.** By building safe aviaries where parrots could live and raise chicks, with help from Hispaniolan foster parrots.
- **D.** By giving up and letting the forests grow back on their own.

Q28 RI.5.3

According to the text, why did scientists build deep, dark nesting boxes for the parrots?

- **A.** Pearly-eyed thrashers like to see the bottoms of nests, so deep boxes kept the thrashers away.
- **B.** The parrots wanted boxes that were bright and shallow.
- **C.** Deep boxes were cheaper and faster to build.
- **D.** The boxes were used to store the parrots' food.

Q29 RI.5.8

What evidence shows that the recovery program was making progress?

- **A.** The number of wild parrots quickly dropped to zero.
- **B.** By 1999, the Río Abajo Aviary had fifty-four Puerto Rican parrots, and captive-bred parrots were released into the wild.
- **C.** Scientists stopped checking on the parrots.
- **D.** The aviaries were closed down after one year.

Q30 RI.5.5

How does the author mainly organize this informational text?

- **A.** As a set of cooking steps.
- **B.** As a play with characters and scenes.
- **C.** As a single rhyming poem.
- **D.** In time order, showing the problems the parrots faced and the solutions people tried.

Q31 RI.5.6

Why do the authors repeat the parrots' call, "Iguaca! Iguaca!", throughout the text?

- **A.** To grab the reader's attention and help the reader "hear" the parrots across the whole history.
- **B.** To explain how to build a fort.
- **C.** To list the names of the scientists.
- **D.** To give directions to El Yunque.

Q32 RI.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a central idea of "Parrots Over Puerto Rico"?

- **A.** The bright blue feathers of the parrots are the most important part of the story.
- **B.** Natural disasters like hurricanes were the only real danger the parrots faced.
- **C.** Human actions both endangered the Puerto Rican parrot and, through years of careful work, helped bring it back.
- **D.** The history of Puerto Rico's forts and harbor is the focus of the whole text.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 5 · Project Earth · Grade 5

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how caring for Earth and its living things can improve life. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"Potatoes on Rooftops,"** Hadley Dyer argues that people can grow food in cities. Show a PROBLEM city gardeners face and a SOLUTION the author describes, then explain why growing food in cities matters.

PROBLEM & SOLUTION · POTATOES ON ROOFTOPS

A PROBLEM OF GROWING FOOD IN CITIES	A SOLUTION THE AUTHOR DESCRIBES

Why does growing food in cities matter for people now and in the future? Use the word *urban* in your answer.

Q2 Causation DOK 3

In **"Parrots Over Puerto Rico,"** human actions both harmed and helped the parrots. Show one CAUSE and its EFFECT, then explain how people brought the parrots back.

CAUSE AND EFFECT · PARROTS OVER PUERTO RICO

A HUMAN ACTION (CAUSE)	→	WHAT HAPPENED TO THE PARROTS (EFFECT)

How did people work to save the parrots from dying out? Use the word *endangered* in your answer.

Q3 Change DOK 3

In **"The Good Garden,"** Don Pedro's ideas change Maria Luz's garden and her family. Show the STEPS, then explain how learning to care for the soil changed her family's life.

HOW THE GARDEN CHANGED · THE GOOD GARDEN

THE PROBLEM	WHAT MARIA LUZ DID	THE RESULT
what was wrong at the start?	*what new ways did she learn?*	*how did things change?*

How did learning to "feed the soil" change Maria Luz's family's life? Use one detail from the story.

Q4 Community DOK 3

In **"Living Green,"** three friends change how they think about caring for the planet. Show what they BELIEVED at first and what they DECIDED to do, then explain what the play shows about small actions.

A CHANGE OF MINDSET · LIVING GREEN

WHAT BO THOUGHT AT FIRST	WHAT THE FRIENDS DECIDED TO DO

What does the play show about how small, everyday actions can help the environment? Explain using one detail.

Q5 Inquiry DOK 4

Essential Question: How can caring for Earth and its living things improve life now and in the future? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

How does caring for Earth or its living things improve life in this selection?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

How does caring for Earth or its living things improve life in this selection?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 5 · Project Earth · Grade 5

MAP RIT 205 → 225 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Empty Lot

For as long as Mateo could remember, the corner of his block had been an empty lot full of weeds and broken bricks. People threw their trash there, and no one ever cleaned it up. One spring, his grandmother looked at the lot and said, "That sad little space could feed half the street." Mateo laughed, but she was not joking. The next Saturday, she handed him a rake. Neighbors came out to see what the old woman was doing. Slowly, one by one, they began to help. They hauled away the trash and pulled the weeds. A man brought a truckload of good soil. A girl from the building shared seeds her family had saved. By summer, the ugly lot had turned green. Tomatoes climbed up strings, beans curled around poles, and bright flowers leaned toward the sun. Anyone who helped could take home what they needed. Mateo liked the lettuce best, but most of all he liked the way the neighbors now stopped to talk. People who had never spoken before traded recipes over the fence. "You see?" his grandmother said, wiping the dirt from her hands. "When you care for a small piece of the Earth, it cares for all of us back."

206 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 205–211

Q1 RIT 205 · Lexile 620L · Key Detail

What did the corner lot look like at the start of the passage?

- ◯ **A.** A green garden full of vegetables.
- ◯ **B.** An empty lot full of weeds, broken bricks, and trash.
- ◯ **C.** A busy playground for the children.
- ◯ **D.** A parking lot for the neighbors' cars.

Q2 RIT 207 · Lexile 640L · Cause & Effect

What happened after Mateo and his grandmother started cleaning the lot?

- ◯ **A.** The city told them to stop.
- ◯ **B.** They gave up after one day.
- ◯ **C.** Neighbors came out and, one by one, began to help.
- ◯ **D.** The weeds grew back even thicker.

Q3 RIT 208 · Lexile 660L · Key Detail

Who could take home food from the new garden?

- ◯ **A.** Anyone who helped could take home what they needed.
- ◯ **B.** Only Mateo and his grandmother.
- ◯ **C.** Only people who paid for it.
- ◯ **D.** No one was allowed to pick anything.

Q4 RIT 210 · Lexile 685L · Inference

Besides food, what else did the garden bring to the neighborhood?

- ◯ **A.** More trash and broken bricks.
- ◯ **B.** Fewer visitors than before.
- ◯ **C.** A new parking lot.
- ◯ **D.** Neighbors who now stopped to talk and grew closer.

Q5 RIT 211 · Lexile 700L · Theme

What is the main message, or theme, of this passage?

- ◯ **A.** An empty lot is too far gone for ordinary neighbors to ever change it.
- ◯ **B.** Growing vegetables is mainly a way to save money on food.
- ◯ **C.** When people care for a small piece of the Earth, it can bring a whole community together.
- ◯ **D.** Only an older person could have known how to fix the lot.

Passage 2 · Feeding the Soil

Healthy soil is not just dirt. It is alive. A single handful can hold billions of tiny living things, from worms and insects to bacteria too small to see. These living things break down dead leaves and food scraps and turn them into food for plants. When soil is rich and full of life, plants grow strong. When it is worn out, plants struggle, no matter how much water they get. For thousands of years, farmers have known a secret: if you want to feed people, you must first feed the soil. One of the oldest ways to do this is composting. Instead of throwing away vegetable peels, eggshells, and grass clippings, a gardener piles them up and keeps them damp. Over time, worms and bacteria break the pile down into a dark, crumbly material called compost. Mixed into a garden, compost returns nutrients to the soil and helps it hold water. Composting also keeps waste out of landfills, so it helps the planet in two ways at once. Some farmers add other tricks. They plant cover crops that protect the ground from washing away, and they rotate their crops so the soil is not drained of the same nutrients year after year. Caring for the soil today keeps it healthy for the harvests of tomorrow.

216 WORDS · LEXILE 740–840L · RIT 211–217

Q6 RIT 211 · Lexile 740L · Key Detail

According to the passage, what can a single handful of healthy soil hold?

- **A.** Billions of tiny living things, such as worms, insects, and bacteria.
- **B.** Only sand and small stones.
- **C.** Nothing alive at all.
- **D.** A cup of clean water.

Q7 RIT 213 · Lexile 770L · Vocabulary

In the passage, the word **compost** means —

- **A.** a kind of garden tool.
- **B.** a bag of store-bought seeds.
- **C.** a deep hole dug in a field.
- **D.** a dark, crumbly material made when waste breaks down, used to enrich soil.

Q8 RIT 214 · Lexile 800L · Cause & Effect

According to the passage, how does composting help the planet in two ways at once?

- **A.** It makes plants taller and turns the sky bluer.
- **B.** It returns nutrients to the soil AND keeps waste out of landfills.
- **C.** It waters the garden and feeds the worms only.
- **D.** It removes all the insects from the soil.

Q9 RIT 215 · Lexile 820L · Author's Purpose

Why does the author include cover crops and crop rotation near the end?

- **A.** To prove that composting does not work.
- **B.** To explain how to cook vegetables.
- **C.** To show other ways farmers protect and care for the soil.
- **D.** To list the names of common farm animals.

Q10 RIT 217 · Lexile 840L · Main Idea

What is the main idea of "Feeding the Soil"?

- **A.** Caring for the living soil keeps it healthy and helps it feed people now and in the future.
- **B.** Composting is a useful trick, but it is only one small detail about gardening.
- **C.** The passage is mostly about the worms and bacteria that live in the ground.
- **D.** As long as plants get plenty of water, the kind of soil does not matter.

Passage 3 · The Last Drop

Nina thought saving the planet was a job for scientists, not for an eleven-year-old. Then her teacher asked the class to keep a "waste diary" for one week. Every time they threw something away or let something run to waste, they wrote it down. By Friday, Nina's list shocked her. She had tossed half a sandwich almost every day. She had left the water running while she brushed her teeth. She had taken long showers and forgotten to turn off the lights when she left a room. "I'm only one kid," she told her mother. "What does it matter?" Her mother smiled and did the math. If one person wasted that much, what about a whole city of people? That weekend, Nina decided to try. She put a timer by the shower and kept it short. She filled a cup to rinse instead of running the tap. She started saving the food she didn't finish for lunch the next day. None of it felt like much. But at the end of the month, her family's water bill had dropped, and the kitchen trash was lighter. Nina realized her mother had been right. One person could not fix everything alone. But if everyone saved their own "last drop," all those small amounts would add up to something huge.

217 WORDS · LEXILE 760–860L · RIT 217–222

Q11 RIT 217 Lexile 760L Key Detail

What did Nina's teacher ask the class to do for one week?

- **A.** Plant a garden at school.
- **B.** Write a report about scientists.
- **C.** Bring food scraps to class.
- **D.** Keep a "waste diary" of everything they threw away or let go to waste.

Q12 RIT 218 Lexile 790L Character

How does Nina feel about saving the planet at the START of the passage?

- **A.** She is sure she can fix everything by herself.
- **B.** She thinks it is a job for scientists, not for one kid like her.
- **C.** She is excited to start right away.
- **D.** She refuses to keep the diary at all.

Q13 RIT 219 Lexile 820L Cause & Effect

What happened after Nina changed her habits for a month?

- **A.** Her water bill went up and the trash got heavier.
- **B.** Nothing changed at all.
- **C.** Her family's water bill dropped and the kitchen trash was lighter.
- **D.** She decided to stop trying.

Q14 RIT 220 · Lexile 840L · Inference

Why does Nina's mother do "the math" about a whole city of people?

- ◯ **A.** To show that small amounts of waste add up to a lot when many people do it.
- ◯ **B.** To prove that Nina should give up.
- ◯ **C.** To help Nina with her homework problems.
- ◯ **D.** To explain how a water bill is printed.

Q15 RIT 222 · Lexile 860L · Theme

What is the main message, or theme, of this passage?

- ◯ **A.** Saving the planet is a job for scientists, not for a single young person.
- ◯ **B.** One person's everyday choices are far too small to ever be worth the effort.
- ◯ **C.** The main reason to cut down on waste is to lower the family's bills.
- ◯ **D.** One person cannot fix everything alone, but small actions by everyone add up to a big difference.

Passage 4 · Bringing the Birds Back

A hundred years ago, the California condor ruled the western skies. With wings stretching nearly ten feet, it is one of the largest flying birds in North America. But by the 1980s, the great bird was almost gone. Power lines, hunting, and a poison called lead, which the condors swallowed when they fed on animals shot by hunters, had pushed the species to the edge. By 1982, fewer than two dozen condors were left alive in the entire world. Scientists faced a hard choice. They decided on a bold and risky plan: they would capture every remaining wild condor and care for the birds in special centers. There, away from the dangers of the wild, the condors could lay eggs in safety. Keepers raised the chicks carefully, sometimes using hand puppets shaped like adult condors so the young birds would not grow too used to people. Slowly, the number of condors began to climb. Years later, scientists started returning the birds to the wild, releasing them above the canyons where their kind had once soared. The work is not finished, and the condors still face dangers. But a bird that almost vanished forever now flies free again. Their recovery is a reminder that even a species on the edge can be saved when people decide to act.

217 WORDS · LEXILE 860–960L · RIT 219–225

Q16 RIT 219 · Lexile 860L · Key Detail

According to the passage, what is the California condor?

- ◯ **A.** A small songbird that lives in cities.
- ◯ **B.** One of the largest flying birds in North America, with wings nearly ten feet across.
- ◯ **C.** A bird that cannot fly at all.
- ◯ **D.** A kind of fish found in canyons.

Q17 RIT 220 | Lexile 890L | Cause & Effect

According to the passage, what pushed the condor to the edge of dying out?

- **A.** Power lines, hunting, and lead poison the birds swallowed from animals shot by hunters.
- **B.** The birds simply grew too large to fly.
- **C.** Other birds chased them out of the sky.
- **D.** They flew south and never returned.

Q18 RIT 221 | Lexile 910L | Key Detail

Why did keepers sometimes use hand puppets shaped like adult condors?

- **A.** To teach the chicks how to swim.
- **B.** To frighten the chicks away from food.
- **C.** To help the chicks learn to read.
- **D.** So the young birds would not grow too used to people.

Q19 RIT 223 | Lexile 935L | Author's Purpose

Why does the author say the work "is not finished" near the end?

- **A.** To prove the condor cannot be saved.
- **B.** To explain how to build a power line.
- **C.** To remind readers that the condors still face dangers even though they are recovering.
- **D.** To show that scientists stopped caring about the birds.

Q20 RIT 225 | Lexile 960L | Main Idea

What is the main idea of "Bringing the Birds Back"?

- **A.** The huge size of the condor's wings is the most important thing about it.
- **B.** Even a species on the edge of dying out can be saved when people decide to act.
- **C.** Because the work is not finished, the effort to save the condor mostly failed.
- **D.** The clever hand puppets were the one thing that saved the condors.